

Now all the woods are sleeping

Text: Paul Gerhardt, 1648

tr. and alt. Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

O WELT, ICH MUSS DICH LASSEN 776.778

Music: Heinrich Isaac, 1539

The musical score is written on three staves in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The melody is simple and folk-like, with a mix of quarter and eighth notes. The lyrics are printed below the notes, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across notes. The first staff contains the first two lines of the hymn, the second staff contains the next two lines, and the third staff contains the final two lines. The piece concludes with a double bar line.

1 Now all the woods are sleep - ing, the night and still - ness creep - ing
2 Why Sun, are you re - treat - ing, and Moon, in dance, now lead - ing
3 Now ob - li - ga - tion ceas - es, this Night the tired re - leas - es
4 My loved ones, rest se - cure - ly, from ev - 'ry per - il sure - ly

o'er ci - ty, field, and beast; but thou, my heart, a - wake be,
the anc - ient bal - lad, Night? Re - flect - ing rays, we glist - en,
and bids you sleep be - gin: My love, there comes a mor - row
pro - tect - ed be your heads; may hap - py slum - bers mend you,

with pray'r - ful thanks, at - tend thee, to dear - est Trea - sures ere thou rest.
we laugh, and talk, and list - en, re - sound - ing, gen - tle notes of light.
shall set thee free from sor - row, and all the anx - ious toil with - in.
and ev - 'ry care at - tend you, as trus - ted souls watch o'er your beds.